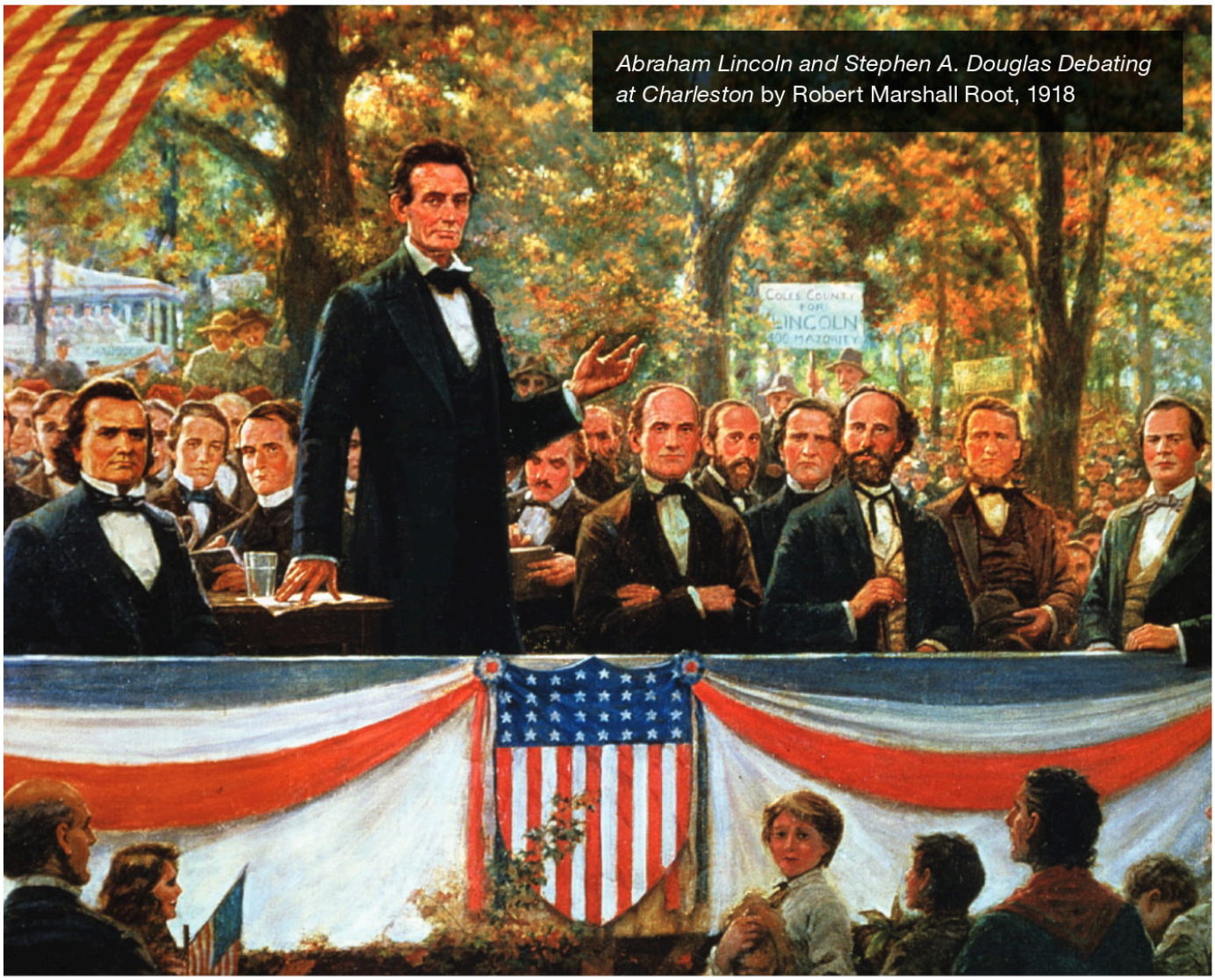
DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

2.3 Lincoln and Douglas

Republican Abraham Lincoln and Democrat Stephen Douglas opposed each other in two political races. In 1858, they fought for the U.S. Senate seat in Illinois, which Douglas won. In 1860, they ran against each other for president, with Lincoln the victor. Although both men disliked slavery, they had different views on the issue.

Lincoln and Douglas engaged in a series of debates during their race for the Illinois Senate seat. Their fourth debate was held on September 18, 1858, in Charleston, Illinois. There, Douglas attacked Lincoln by saying that his opponent favored racial equality, an unpopular position at the time, even in the North. The painting below shows Lincoln speaking to the crowd gathered for the outdoor event. Douglas sits to Lincoln's right, waiting his turn to speak.

CRITICAL VIEWING How does the artist portray the debate?



Abraham Lincoln and Stephen A. Douglas Debating at Charleston by Robert Marshall Root, 1918

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DOCUMENT ONE

Primary Source: Speech
from Abraham Lincoln's speech at the Republican Convention in Springfield, Illinois, on June 16, 1858

This speech is known as the "House Divided" speech. Lincoln used a Bible metaphor, comparing the nation to a house, to express his view of the impact that conflicting laws about slavery were having on the country as a whole.

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE What does Lincoln think will happen to the Union if the division continues?

> "A house divided against itself cannot stand." I believe this government cannot endure, permanently, half slave and half free. I do not expect the Union to be dissolved; I do not expect the house to fall; but I do expect it will cease to be divided. It will become all one thing, or all the other.

DOCUMENT TWO

Primary Source: Speech
from Stephen Douglas's speech at the Lincoln-Douglas debate in Freeport, Illinois, on August 27, 1858

In a debate held in Freeport, Illinois, Douglas addressed a question that Lincoln had put to him: Could the people of a territory keep slavery out? Douglas believed they could and, in this excerpt, he explains how.

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE Describe how Douglas uses cause and effect to explain how people can keep slavery out of a territory.

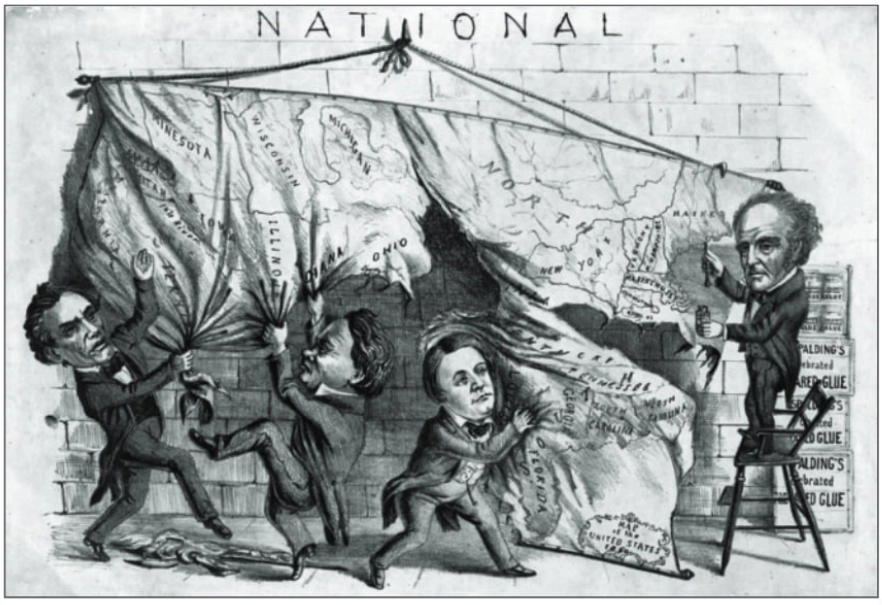
> The people have the lawful means to introduce it [slavery] or exclude it as they please, for the reason that slavery cannot exist a day or an hour anywhere, unless it is supported by local police regulations. Those police regulations can only be established by the local legislature, and if the people are opposed to slavery they will elect representatives to that body who will by unfriendly legislation effectually prevent the introduction of it into their midst.

DOCUMENT THREE

Primary Source: Political Cartoon
from *Harper's Weekly*, 1860

This political cartoon suggests that the issue of slavery is tearing the United States apart. Seen here are the four candidates in the 1860 presidential election. From left to right are Abraham Lincoln, Stephen Douglas, John C. Breckinridge, and John Bell.

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE What details in the cartoon suggest that slavery is tearing the United States apart?



SYNTHESIZE & WRITE

1. **REVIEW** Review what you have learned about Abraham Lincoln and Stephen Douglas and their debates.
2. **RECALL** On your own paper, write the main idea expressed in each document.
3. **CONSTRUCT** Construct a topic sentence that answers this question: What differing positions did Lincoln and Douglas take on the issue of slavery?
4. **WRITE** Using evidence from this chapter and the documents, write an informative paragraph that supports your topic sentence in Step 3.

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